How Clear Is Your Picture of What Mom Owns and What You've Been Told?

Twelve quick questions about what you know. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how complete your family's picture is. It doesn't measure Mom's finances, and nothing here says what she can keep or whether she is eligible for anything.

1. Do you have a written list of what Mom and Dad own: the home, savings, retirement accounts, insurance and anything else of value?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Have you seen the deed to the house, and do you know whose names are on it?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. For each account, do you know whose name or names are printed on the statement?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Do you know which things are owned jointly, and with whom?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Do you know who is named as beneficiary on the retirement accounts and the insurance policies?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Do you know whether there is a trust, and where its papers are?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Have you written down what Dad relies on at home: the house, his own income, and the accounts he pays the bills from?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Have you written down what you've been told about what Mom can keep, and who said each thing?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Has anyone who knows Mom's situation and your state's rules talked with you about the house and about Dad as the spouse at home?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Has anyone explained the difference between Mom qualifying for Medicaid now and the asset and estate questions that may come up later?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Has anyone who knows your state's rules talked with you about estate recovery?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. For each open question, do you know who you'd take it to?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what your family knows and has in hand, not Mom's finances and not what she can keep. A low count means there are things still to find or ask. Several of them, such as the house, estate recovery and the difference between now and later, are what the conversation with a professional is for, so a “no” there is to be expected at this point. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You can see what your family knows for certain, what you've only heard, and what nobody has asked yet. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer, and bring both to your Medicaid planner.

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